

SENATE JOINT RESOLUTION 669

By Massey

A RESOLUTION to honor the memory of Thomas Dexter Justis of
Morristown.

WHEREAS, the members of this General Assembly were greatly saddened to learn of
the untimely passing of Thomas Dexter Justis; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Justis was an esteemed public servant, devoted family man, and widely
admired leader in Tennessee's transportation sector; and

WHEREAS, born on November 18, 1976, in Morristown, Dexter Justis earned both his
Bachelor of Science degree and Master of Science degree in Civil Engineering from the
University of Tennessee; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Justis was a professional civil engineer and transportation leader,
whose career with the Tennessee Department of Transportation (TDOT) spanned nearly
twenty-five years of dedicated service to the people of this State; and

WHEREAS, over the course of his TDOT tenure, Dexter Justis held a number of
positions, including District Operations Engineer, Regional Materials Engineer, Project
Supervisor, and Director of Project Management, culminating in his appointment as Region 1
Director, where he oversaw operations across a twenty-four-county region in East Tennessee;
and

WHEREAS, in this capacity, Mr. Justis provided strategic oversight and leadership in
areas such as highway maintenance and repair, construction engineering, traffic and bridge
safety, materials and testing, environmental planning, and regional office administration,
demonstrating professionalism, insight, and an unwavering commitment to the public good; and

WHEREAS, respected for his extraordinary work ethic, sound judgment, and thoughtful
demeanor, Dexter Justis served as a mentor to many within TDOT and across the engineering
community; and

WHEREAS, in remembering Mr. Justis, TDOT Commissioner Will Reid reflected on his steady optimism and deep connection to the TDOT family, recalling how he often closed conversations with phrases like "we will make it happen" or "we are moving in the right direction," words that captured his quiet confidence and his gift for lifting others up; and

WHEREAS, beyond his professional life, Dexter Justis was a beloved husband, father, son, brother, and friend whose devotion to family was central to all he did; and

WHEREAS, he was a man of deep loyalty and wide affection, known for his big heart, his love for the Tennessee Volunteers, and, above all, his deep-seated faith in God that sustained him throughout his life and informed his service to others; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Justis is survived by his loving wife of twenty-four years, Melanie Justis; daughters, Lucy and Nina; parents, Tommy and Sue Justis; sister and brother-in-law, Libby and Brandon Sullivan; niece, Bonnie; nephew, James Thomas; father-in-law and mother-in-law, John and Phyllis Ricker; brother-in-law, Wesley Ricker; nephews, Cody and family and Logan and family; and a host of extended family members and dear friends; and

WHEREAS, he was preceded in death by his grandparents, Ruth and Hubert "Bo" Tart and Eva and Bill Justis; and

WHEREAS, Dexter Justis leaves behind an indelible legacy of integrity and probity in public life, compassion and loyalty in private life, and diligence and dedication in all his chosen endeavors; and

WHEREAS, it is fitting that we should pause to remember the bountiful life of this exceptional public servant and human being; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE SENATE OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES CONCURRING, that we honor the memory of Thomas Dexter Justis, reflecting fondly upon his impeccable character and his stalwart commitment to living the examined life with courage and conviction.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that we express our sympathy and offer our condolences to the family of Mr. Justis.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.